

TD Canada Trust
66 Wellington Street West,
Toronto, ON M5K 1A2
Canada

Dear Recruitment Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Data Scientist Associate position within the AI2 Associate Program. As a current Customer Experience Associate at TD and a Master of Management in Business Data Analytics student at the University of Windsor, I am eager to bring my background in predictive modeling, statistical testing, and machine learning to the Analytics Insights & AI team.

Working at the branch level has given me a deep appreciation for TD's Culture of Care. In my day-to-day role, I focus on helping clients navigate their accounts and translating complex information to improve their financial literacy. I have also made it a priority to regularly connect with branch manager and MCE to better understand the broader business strategy and identify functional gaps that can be improved. This experience has taught me how to recognize business problems where data can actually make a difference and work with others to develop practical solutions.

My academic and technical projects align perfectly with the program's requirement for predictive analytics and drawing statistical inferences. For my Mortgage Credit Risk Analytics project, I utilized Logistic Regression on Freddie Mac loan data to draw insights on default risk, utilizing SHAP for interpretability and presenting the outputs through an interactive Streamlit dashboard to inform decision-making. Additionally, in my NYC Taxi Payment Analysis, I applied rigorous statistical methods, including hypothesis testing, EDA, and two-sample t-tests using SciPy in Python to uncover behavioral trends in large datasets, demonstrating my ability to extract actionable insights from raw data.

Prior to obtaining my Master's degree, when I was working as a Data Analyst at Janes, I automated the data pipelines in order to get rid of the manual bottlenecks and put into use machine learning classification models that achieved 90% accuracy. Beyond the technical execution using Python, SQL, and advanced MS Excel, my primary focus was always on translating quantitative outputs into clear, actionable recommendations for cross-functional stakeholders, ensuring the data actually drove business value. I have a sound combination of technical ability, a strong interest in business matters, and a real dedication to TD's values, and I would like the chance to apply my analytical problem-solving skills to the AI2 team.

My long-term goal is to work in data science and use data to help solve real business problems. I'm interested in this program because the rotations would let me learn how different teams at TD use data in their day-to-day work. I'd be able to build on what I already know, learn from people with more experience, and get a better sense of the areas I enjoy most. Over time, I want to become someone who can understand a business problem, work with the data behind it, and explain what the results actually mean in a way that helps people make better decisions.

Thank you for taking the time to review my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Yours faithfully,

Shawaiz Akhter